

SAILS ADVISORY

SAILS WORKING DOC · FOR FOUNDERS & REPS

The Velocity Qualification Rubric.

Five binary questions, scored in under a minute, applied to every deal with zero exceptions. The scorecard that keeps junk out of your pipeline and fiction out of your forecast.

4 PAGES · BY MATT WEISMAN

Five points. Score 0 or 1. Evidence only.

Every point needs a sentence the buyer actually said. If the CRM note can't quote it, the point wasn't earned.

1 Trigger · Why this conversation, why now?

Earns the point: the buyer names a specific event (hired reps, lost a deal, missed a quarter, churned off a competitor). **Scores zero:** "they seemed interested," no event named. No trigger means no urgency.

2 Fit · Are they actually your ICP?

Earns the point: verifiable facts match your ICP definition (size, motion, industry, use case). **Scores zero:** "they could probably use it." Out-of-ICP wins churn in month four.

3 Authority · Can this person buy?

Earns the point: your contact owns the decision, or has booked the owner into the next call. **Scores zero:** "I'll share it with my boss." Booked beats promised, every time.

4 Cost of status quo · What does doing nothing cost, in their words?

Earns the point: the buyer states a cost ("we lose about two deals a month because nobody follows up"). **Scores zero:** your pitch reflected back, or no cost named. If they can't say it, they won't fight for the purchase.

5 Path · Is there a buyer-committed next step with a date?

Earns the point: a demo, decision meeting, or pilot scoping on the calendar, committed by the buyer. **Scores zero:** "I'll get back to you." Rep motion is not deal motion.

What the score decides.

SCORE	VERDICT	WHAT TO DO
5 / 5	Qualified, hot	Advance now. Demo booked before the call ends. Cycle target inside 14 days.
4 / 5	Qualified	Advance to demo. Note the missing point; close it on the demo call.
3 / 5	Develop	Exactly one targeted action against the specific gap, with a deadline. Doesn't close in one touch: it's a 2.
0-2 / 5	Not qualified	Nurture track with a revisit date, or a polite no. Does not enter pipeline. This is a win: you just saved six weeks.

The number that matters most is the 3. "Develop" is a state with a timer on it, not a parking lot. One gap-closing action, then up to a 4 or out of the pipeline.

The three checkpoints

- **End of discovery.** Score in the last two minutes of the call while the evidence is fresh. The five points map to the five discovery questions.
- **Entry into pipeline.** No deal enters the CRM as an opportunity below a 4. This one rule does more for forecast accuracy than any forecasting method.
- **Requalification of stalled deals.** When the weekly pipeline review flags a deal past its time-in-stage benchmark twice, run the rubric again on current evidence. Triggers expire. Authority changes. The rubric is how you notice.

The failure modes to watch.

- **Scoring hope instead of evidence.** The fix is the phrase "in their words." Every point needs a quotable sentence from the buyer in the CRM note.
- **Rubric drift.** Reps under quota pressure round 3s up to 4s. The counter is public scoring: the score is said out loud in the pipeline review when the deal enters, and anyone can challenge a point.
- **Treating nurture as failure.** A 2 with a real trigger arriving next quarter is future pipeline. Move it to nurture with a revisit date and it comes back warm. Force it in now and it burns 20 rep-touches dying slowly.

Install checklist

- ☐ ICP definition written and agreed (fit has to be checkable against something)
- ☐ Five score fields added to the CRM opportunity record
- ☐ Entry rule active: no opportunity below a 4
- ☐ Score spoken aloud in the weekly pipeline review when each deal enters
- ☐ Stalled deals requalified with the same rubric, not gut feel

Book a Discovery Call

If "qualified" means something different to every rep on your team, the rubric needs calibrating to your ICP and motion. That's part of the SAILS engagement. 30 minutes, no deck: we'll score your three newest deals against the rubric, live.

calendar.app.google/x2MYasUSFXEeow459